Universal Human Values — II · 21LEM202T

Unit 1 · Session 5 · SLO 1 — Solved Worksheet

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Unit – 1 : Session – 5 | Understanding Happiness Rightly

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

• Q1. HAPPINESS is a state of inner harmony — stable, continuous, independent of external objects. EXCITEMENT is a temporary, heightened pleasant sensation triggered by an external stimulus — it comes, peaks and dies, leaving restlessness for the next dose. THREE SOURCES of happiness: (1) Sensation through the body (taste, sound, touch...) — temporary; (2) Feeling received from others (respect, appreciation) — depends on others; (3) RIGHT UNDERSTANDING & RIGHT FEELING within the Self — the only source that gives CONTINUITY. Excitement belongs to source 1; true continuous happiness comes from source 3.

• Q2. The prevailing notion 'accumulation of wealth = prosperity' is a gross misunderstanding: (a) needs of the Self cannot be fulfilled by wealth at all; (b) without the feeling of 'I have more than required', no amount of accumulation satisfies — the person with little who feels sufficient is prosperous, while a billionaire who feels shortage is deprived; (c) unlimited accumulation drives exploitation of others and nature. True prosperity = right assessment of need + ability to produce more than required; wealth accumulation alone neither defines nor ensures it.

• Q3. SENSATION is temporary — it tires and bores on repetition, so dependence on it forces endless novelty-seeking. PHYSICAL FACILITY gives comfort but never the feeling of enough, so dependence on it fuels unlimited accumulation. FEELING RECEIVED FROM OTHERS is uncertain — others may or may not give it, making my happiness their hostage. Hence none of the three can give CONTINUOUS happiness. The actual ROLE of sensation: sensations are the body's messages, to be read by the Self BY CHOICE — taste guides nutrition, pain signals protection — they are inputs for right utilisation, not masters to be served.